

Excel Compare Professional

User Manual - Version 1.1.0

Developed and published by **AAT-Tech Ltd**

Professional spreadsheet comparison for accountants, auditors, HR teams, schools and businesses.

- Intelligent key-column matching
- Added, deleted, modified and unchanged record detection
- Multi-worksheet comparison
- Colour-coded results
- Excel, PDF and CSV audit exports
- Native .xlsx, .csv and .tsv support
- Legacy .xls, .xlsb, .xlsm, template and OpenDocument support through LibreOffice

1. Supported spreadsheet formats

Format	How it is opened	LibreOffice required
.xlsx	Native QXlsx reader	No
.csv	Built-in CSV reader	No
.tsv / .tab	Built-in tab-delimited reader	No
.xls / .xlsb / .xlsm	Temporary conversion to .xlsx	Yes
.xlt / .xltx / .xltm	Temporary conversion to .xlsx	Yes
.ods / .fods	Temporary conversion to .xlsx	Yes

Important: The original spreadsheet is never modified. Converted workbooks are created inside a temporary folder and removed automatically after loading.

Macros and VBA code are not executed or compared. Password-protected files must be unlocked before use.

Installing LibreOffice

Use the Start Menu shortcut **Install Legacy Format Support**, or run tools\install-libreoffice.bat. Restart Excel Compare Professional after installation.

2. Comparing two files

- 1 Click Browse old and choose the previous spreadsheet.
- 2 Click Browse new and choose the updated spreadsheet.
- 3 Click Load workbooks.
- 4 Select one or more key columns that uniquely identify a record, such as Employee ID, Invoice Number or Student ID.
- 5 Choose whether to compare all worksheets.
- 6 Click Compare workbooks.
- 7 Double-click a result row to see field-level changes.

Status meanings

Added: the key exists only in the new file.

Deleted: the key exists only in the old file.

Modified: the key exists in both files but one or more values changed.

Unchanged: the key and values match.

CSV and TSV files

CSV and TSV inputs are treated as a single worksheet. Quoted CSV fields, embedded delimiters and escaped double quotes are supported.

3. Exporting reports

Use the export buttons after a comparison completes:

- Export Excel creates a formatted .xlsx report with summary and detailed changes.
- Export PDF creates a landscape report suitable for review and printing.
- Export audit CSV creates a machine-readable audit trail with timestamp, worksheet, status, key and before/after values.

Troubleshooting

Legacy format requires LibreOffice: Run the included installation helper and restart the application.

No common key columns: Confirm the first row contains matching column headings in both files.

Duplicate key warning: The last record with a duplicate key is used. Choose additional key columns to make the identity unique.

Large workbooks: Close other memory-intensive applications and allow the background operation to finish.

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